

Communication

-NILAM SANGROULA

Origin of Communication

- The word ‘communication’ comes from the Latin word *communis* which means common. This implies that when we communicate, we are trying to establish ‘commonality’ with someone through a message.
- Communication, then, is a conscious attempt to establish commonality over some idea, fact, feelings and the like, with others. In essence, it is a process of getting a source and a receiver tuned together for a particular message or a series of messages.

Definitions

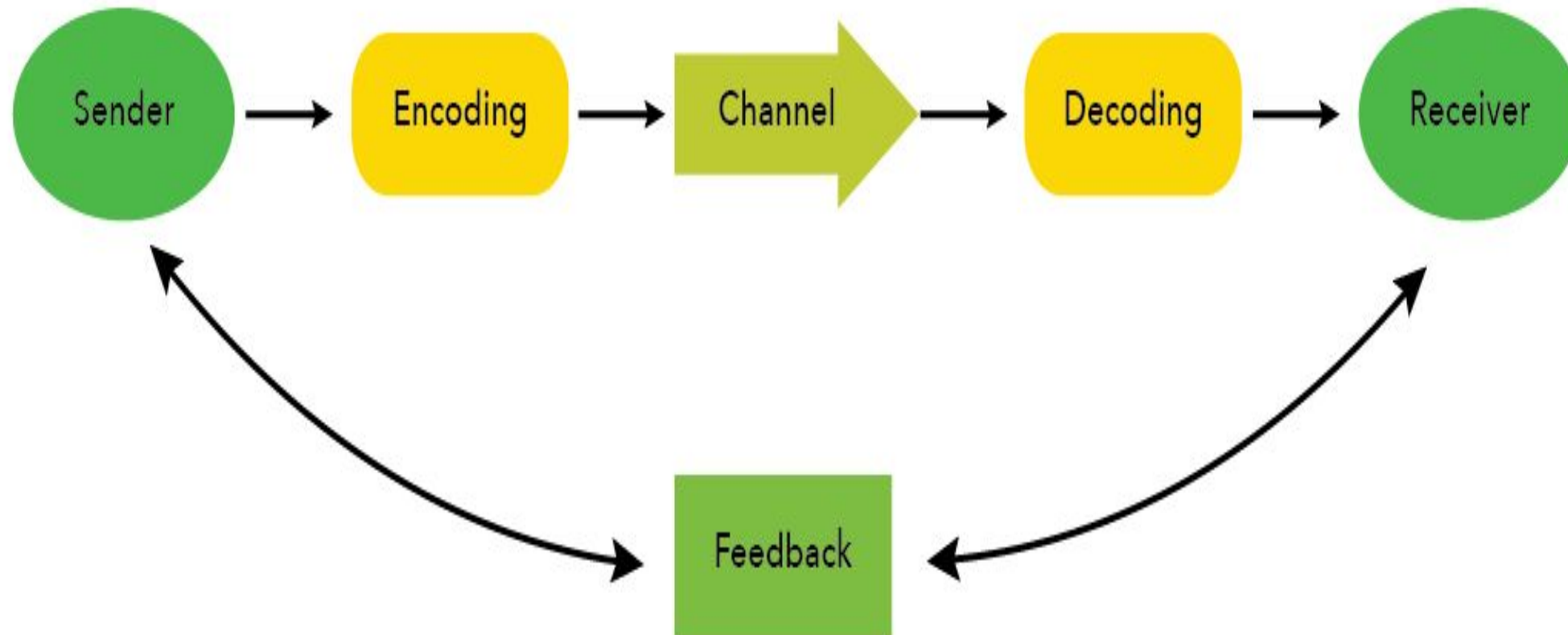
- Communication is anything that conveys meaning, that carries a message from one person to another. – *Brooker.*
- Communication is the mutual interchange of ideas by any effective means. – *Thayer.*
- Communication in its simplest form is conveying of information from one person to another. – *Cyril L Hudson.*

- Communication is the act of making one's ideas and opinions known to others. – *Fred. G. Meyer.*
- Communication is the process of passing information and understanding from one person to another. – *Keith Davis.*
- Communication is a process by which two or more people exchange ideas, facts, feelings or impressions in ways that each gains a common understanding of meaning, intent and use of message. – *Leagans.*

Lee Thayer's Four Functions of Communication

- The information function :
 - It serves to provide knowledge to the individuals who need guidance in their actions. It also fulfils the workers' desires for awareness of things that affect them.
- The command and instructive function :
 - This function makes the employee aware of his obligations to the formal organisation and provides him with additional guidance on how to perform his/her duties adequately.
- The influence and persuasive function :
 - This function motivates, directs and guides the employees to act and influence the behavior and attitudes of the people through arguments and persuasion.
- The integrative function :
 - Communication, if properly handled, integrates the activities and efforts of the workers. As a result, they move in a single desired direction and the whole organization becomes a well-knit system.

Communication Process Model



Rogers and Shoemaker's (1971) "SMCRE" Communication model

- Source :
 - It is the point of origin of the message. The person who starts the process of communication is also called the communicator. The communicator decides what message is to be sent, how to treat it, what channel to use and which receivers to reach.
- Message :
 - A message is the information a communicator wishes his audience to receive, understand, accept and act upon. The message may be information, instructions or orders.
- Channel :
 - It is anything used by a communicator of messages to connect him with the intended receivers. It may be a letter, meeting, radio, newspaper, television etc. through which the communicator reaches the receivers.
- Receivers :
 - Receivers are the intended audience of messages. They are the consumer of the messages. The communicator should identify and aim his messages towards his intended audience.
- Effect :
 - Effect is the response by the audience to the messages received by them. This may be some kind of mental or physical action. The action should be viewed as a product of the communication process.

Communication Network

- A communication network is a pattern or form that is implemented in the organization to communicate information effectively.
- **4 Types of Communication Network**
- **Wheel Network**
 - Under the wheel communication network, the leader of the organization works as a central person to accumulate information and disseminate it to all the members. In-wheel network, the top-level manager is the source of information. S/he provides information within and outside the organization. Within the organization, S/he provides information to subordinates and also accumulates required information from them.
 - In short, in the wheel network, a top-level manager is the source of information, s/he collects, generates, and disseminates information to all the organizational mechanisms.

• Chain Network

- The chain network has all the appearance of an organizational chain of command. It is the vertical upward and downward form of the formal chain of communication. In this communication network, a person can communicate only with his/her immediate superior and subordinate.
- In short, a chain network is the vertical form of communication in which a person can communicate only with his immediate superior and subordinate.

• Circle Network

- It is a horizontal or sideward form of a circle network. In this network, a person can communicate to another person next to his right or left but not with any other member of the group. Such a network offers a wider option of channels and provides satisfaction to members.
- For example, in a meeting, a member converses with the member on his right or left. Similarly, in the formal organizations, a production manager communicates to the marketing or finance manager to get official information.

- **All Channel Network**

- In all channel networks, all members can communicate with all the members without any formal restrictions.
- It is an informal form of the network where all members can communicate their ideas, views, and suggestions to all the members of the group.
- Members have more freedom to flow information among the group members. The leader of the group does not hold exceptional power to control group members. Therefore, it is known as an open communication network.

Barriers in the Communication Environment

- Physical and Mechanical Barriers
 - Noise
 - Distance
 - Time
 - Information overload
 - Physical barriers
 - Use of words with different meanings
 - Denotations and Connotations



• Language or Semantic Barriers

- Unclear message
- Words or Symbols with different
- Technical words or jargons
- Faulty translation
- Unclarified assumptions
- Body language and gestures



• Socio-Psychological Barriers

- Differences in perception
- Differences in attitude
- Emotions
- Inattention
- Closed minds
- Premature evaluation
- Distrust
- Resistance to change
- Cultural differences

- Organisational Barriers
 - Status relationship
 - One-way flow
 - Complex organization
 - Rigid rules and regulations
 - Distance barriers
 - Physical barriers
 - Mechanical barriers

•Personal Barriers

- Attitude of superiors
- Lack of confidence in subordinates
- Insistence of proper channel
- Ignoring Communication
- Filtering of information

Francis J. Bergin's Principles of Effective Communication

- Completeness
- Conciseness
- Correctness
- Concreteness
- Clarity
- Consideration (careful thought)
- Courtesy

Listening Process

Five Stages of the Listening Process



Types of Listening

- Active listening
 - Understanding all things
 - Proper interaction
 - Proper feedback
- Selective listening
 - Understanding all things
 - Proper interaction
 - Proper feedback
- Emphatic listening
 - When we listen empathetically, we go beyond sympathy to seek a truer understand how others are feeling.
- Ignoring listening
 - Not listening at all
 - Is pretty insulting to others.
 - It can lead to strained relations

How To Listen Effectively?

- Stop Talking – Be Silent
- Show Interest
- Empathize
- Ask Questions
- Maintain Eye Contact
- Take notes
- Listen Creatively
- Put Your Entirety
- Send feedback
- Avoid or eliminate distraction
- Try to gather information about the topic to develop interest and familiarity.

Benefits of Effective Listening

- Enhances productivity •Improves relations
- Avoids conflicts
- Improves understanding
- Improves negotiation skills
- Adds to your Image & Personality

Current Issues in Communication

- Misinformation and Fake News
 - The proliferation of misinformation and fake news has become a significant issue in communication. With the rise of social media and online platforms, false information can spread rapidly, leading to confusion, mistrust, and potentially harmful consequences.
- Privacy and Data Security
 - The handling of personal data and privacy concerns have been growing issues in communication. With the increasing collection and analysis of user data by companies, there are concerns about data breaches, unauthorized access, and the potential misuse of personal information.
- Digital Divide
 - The digital divide refers to the gap between those who have access to technology and the internet and those who do not. Unequal access to communication technologies and internet connectivity can create disparities in education, job opportunities, and access to information.

• Online Harassment and Cyberbullying

- The anonymity and distance provided by online platforms have given rise to online harassment and cyberbullying. Individuals can be subjected to abusive behavior, threats, and harassment, which can have severe emotional and psychological impacts.

• Digital Fatigue and Information Overload

- The constant connectivity and overwhelming amount of information can lead to digital fatigue and information overload. With the rapid pace of communication and the need to stay constantly updated, individuals may feel overwhelmed, stressed, and find it challenging to process the vast amount of information effectively.

• Language and Cultural Barriers

- Communication across different languages and cultures can present challenges in understanding and effective communication. Misinterpretation, stereotypes, and cultural differences can hinder clear communication and create misunderstandings.

Case to be discussed

- Mr. Tony had recently been hired as the manager of an online retailer. His appointment was announced through an e-mail to all company employees, and his department was expecting his arrival. The CEO told him his first task was to try to cut costs in the department. Tony hadn't determined exactly what to do, but he had determined that he could reach the target cuts through a combination of a freeze on new hiring, cutting all but critical travel, reducing training, and cutting back on the use of temporary and contract workers.
- He was anxious to show his superiors that he was working on the problem, so he sent an e-mail to his managers and employees that said he would be announcing cost-cutting measures soon. Unfortunately, employees interpreted this to mean there would be layoffs. Rumors soon started flying about how "Matt the Knife" had been hired to outsource the department and that everyone was going to be laid off. Morale plunged and people started using their time to polish their resumes and apply for jobs. The employees distrusted Tony and he was cut off from all but routine communication with them.